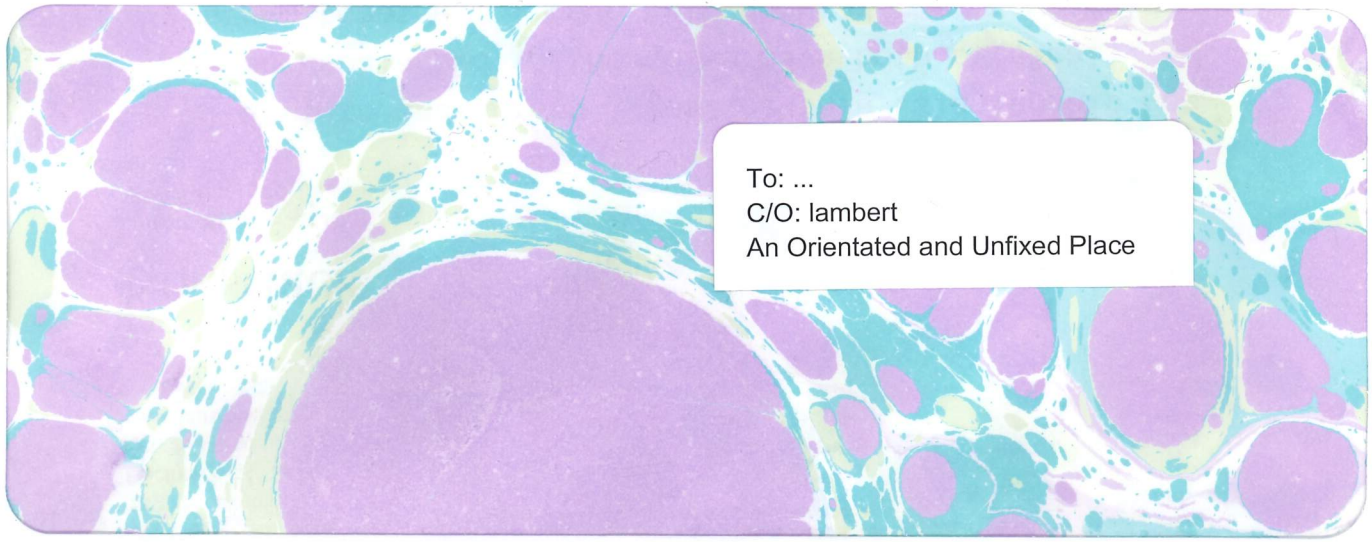
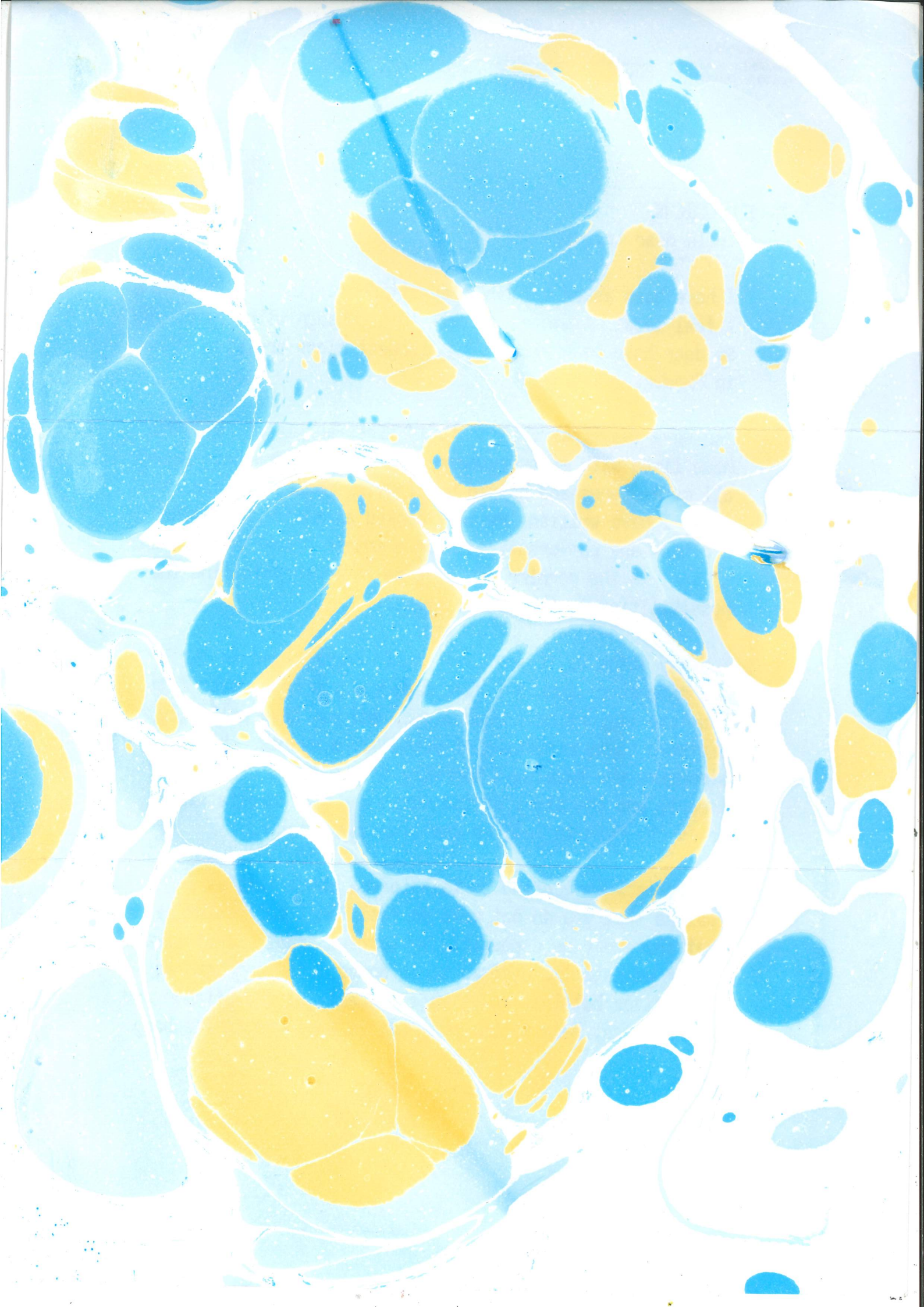


Cruising with Craft to the Ends of the Worlds: Practices of shattering, becoming scyborg and dancing with dragons as possible cartographies. lambert, matt (the local)
ISBN 978 91-85549-73-3 Series: Konstfack Dissertation Collection 11



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Hello dear friend,

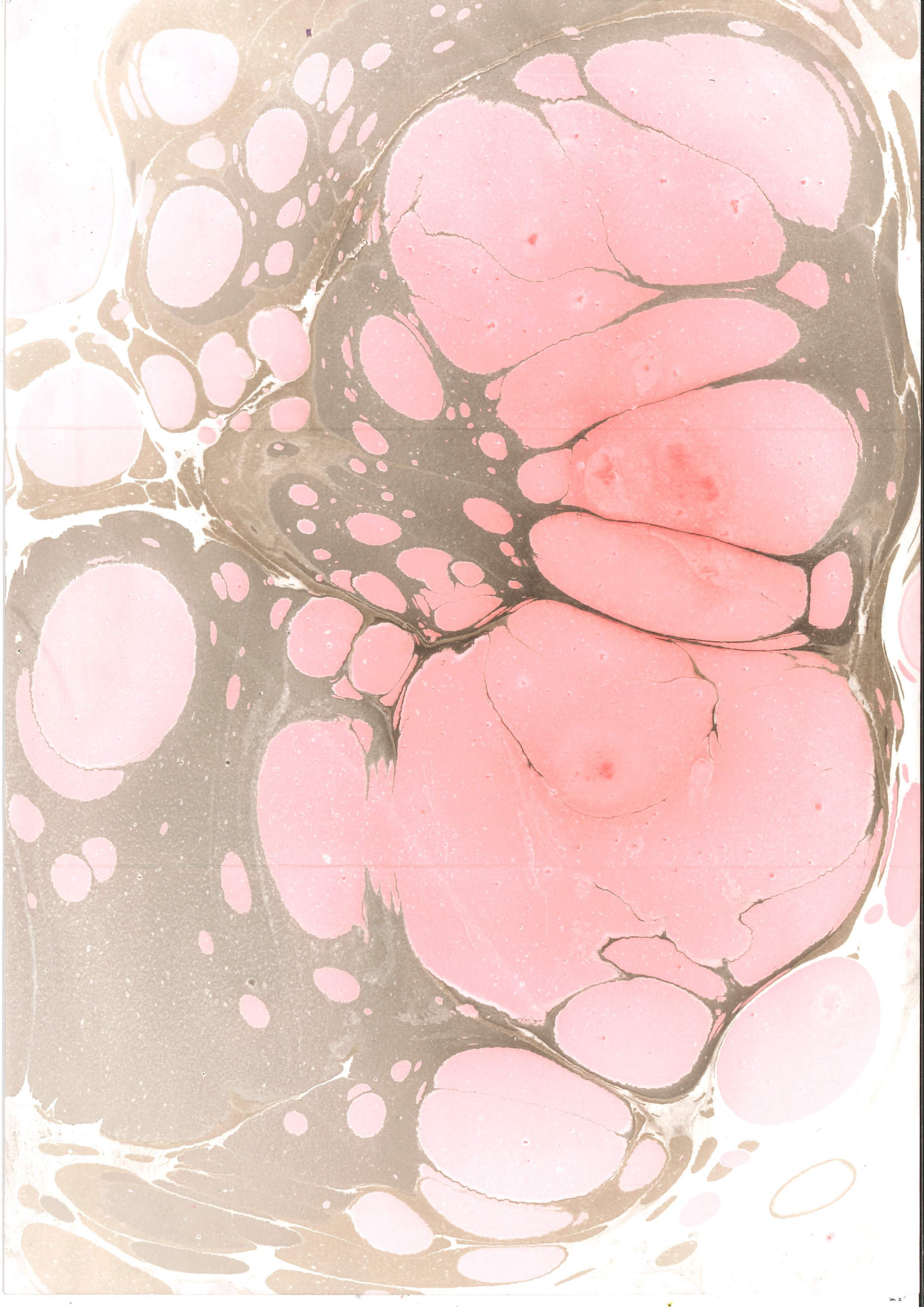
I have been asked a funny proposition to find a place where I feel local. I wanted to talk this through with you as you my dear have been with me the longest since arriving here in Sweden.

You were the first visitor to my first apartment, and you have lived with me everywhere I have moved. You have heard all my lectures and helped proof every paper, article, and essay I have written. We have cooked alongside each other and had many conversations over a shared drink. Daily when we meet in the morning you give me the energy to find the possibilities in the day to exist.

You may judge me for my late nights coming home or the bad choices of lovers I have made but you have never left. Your expressions have been stoic, and you have patiently listened to my rehashing of yesterday's events, the strangers who have said horrible things to me on my commute and the story of the women who just had to stop me in the rain to tell me she liked my sweater.

I suppose I am wanting to talk to you about this as I realize that you do not make me feel local but remind me that there may be a possibility to feel local ... at times ... in moments ... Just as Sarah Ahmed describes home as not a place but instead it is the smells of the kitchen and in the energy held in moments that is kept within the body.

Best,



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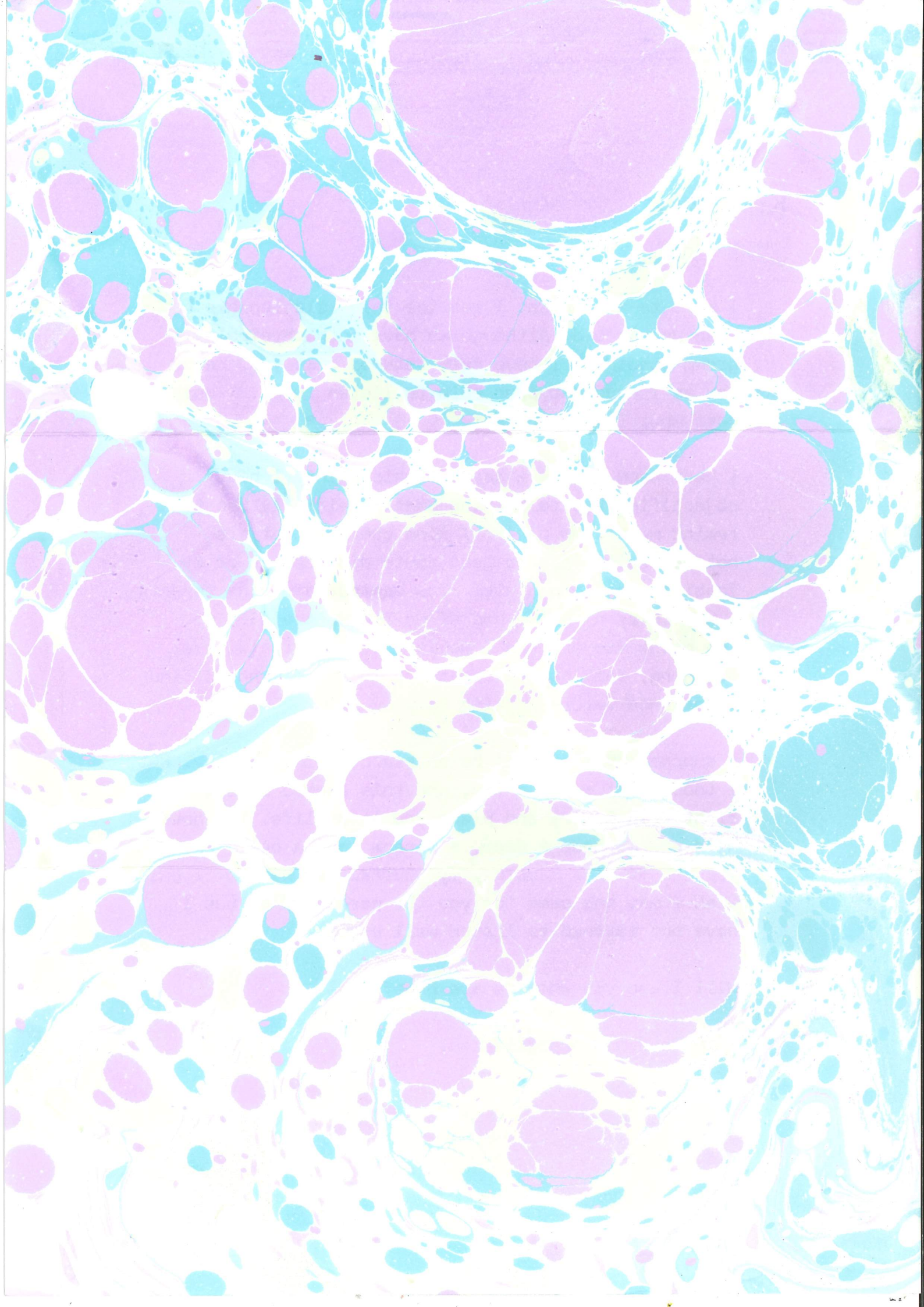
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Hello dear,

I wanted to pick up our last conversation. I realize that you have little say in how you have been labeled, your name was given to you by a taxonomist and the western hetero normative regimes have poked, cut, and displaced you and your kin. What name would you like to be called? Are you content or happy to live with me? I still cannot apologize enough for when my new roommate helped me move and she bumped into you giving you a great shock which I can still see you are slowly recovering from.

I am told that you scream ... you scream when you are worried about being harmed. I am also told you scream when you want for something ... when you need something. You have listened to my screams, my longings for a location, my frustrations with my own name and the weights that are placed by western hetero normative regimes on my shoulders and my spirit. I wish I could hear your screams; I wish I could find equanimity with you. This I am aware as Robin Wall Kimmerer has said over and over requires a new kind of listening. But of course, you know this as we have listened to her read over many long sleepless nights. I promise to keep trying to listen to you.

With care,



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Hello,

I want to apologize. I realize this relationship has been unbalanced. Although we have both physically grown together, I have only assumed what your needs are as I have not been able to listen fully. I only hear what I want to hear.

I have used you as a cartographic point. I have objectified you to a thing that I selfishly use to remind me of the places I find comfort that are not accessible due to geographic dislocation or my inability to time travel. You remind me of the forests I hid in as a child, and of my frequent visits to the plant store where I would just walk the aisles touching, talking and breathing in an attempt to find my balance before walking to you.

I suppose this may all be an exercise in futility. But I thought it worth a try, and this seemed like the right time to try and place you in my life. You have held space, been a door, a window, and a bell. Perhaps you are my time machine, my journal, my keeper. I only wish I was the same for you. Or perhaps I am but I have not learned to listen well enough?

Will I see you when we are home?

With love and appreciation,